ACTIVITY - 4

List some recipes based on nuts and oils in our diet?

5. 3 Fats and oils

Fat is an important component of our diet and serves a number of functions in the body. Fat provides our body with energy. Although we can get energy from other nutrients in our diet, we need some fat as it provides essential fatty acids that our body cannot make. It is also a carrier of the fat-soluble vitamins and is necessary for their absorption. In general, no more than about one third of our energy intake should come from fat as too much fat can be associated with high energy intakes that can lead to weight gain.

5.3. 1.Nutritional significance

- A small amount of fat is an essential part of a healthy, balanced diet.

Role of fats in cooking

- They have high energy value.
- Impart palatability to diet.
- Add flavour and texture to the food.
- Improve taste and blends well with the food.
- Makes the food crispy.

In common usage, it is classified as fats and oils. Fats are solid at room temperature where as oils are liquid at room temperature.

DO YOU KNOW...?

1. Saturated eg. Butter, coconut oil
2. Mono unsaturated eg., olive oil
3. Poly unsaturated eg. Vegetable seed oil (soya been , corn, cotton seed)

Table 5.1 fatty acid composition of oil

Oil / Fats	Total Saturated	Total mono unsaturated	Total poly unsaturated
Groundnut oil	20.9	49.3	29.9
Coconut oil	89.5	7.8	2.0
Mustard oil	10.7	56.0	32.6
Sunflower	9.1	25.1	66.2
Sesame	13.7	41.3	44.5
Palm Oil	46.3	43.7	10.0
Olive Oil	14.8	74.5	10.0
Corn oil	12.7	29.6	57.4

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